```
preg_match_all('/\d+/', '12345', $matches);
print_r($matches[0]);
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => 12345
)
```

The pattern /\d+/ is a simple expression meaning "one or more digits." The sample is '12345', the match is greedy, so it consumes all five digits. If we switch to non-greedy…

```
preg_match_all('/\d+?/', '12345', $matches);
print_r($matches[0]);
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => 1
    [1] => 2
    [2] => 3
    [3] => 4
    [4] => 5
)
```

… we get the bare minimum that satisfies the "one or more digits" condition, which gives us five matches of one digit each.

Character Classes

Some escape sequences, such as \w, \d, and \s, define multiple characters. \d matches any of 0123456789, for example. These are character type escapes, sets of characters with common properties (Unicode properties are functionally the same thing too). It is possible to define custom character sets too, using the [and] metacharacters to form a *character class*. Within a character class definition, there are some differences in behavior with certain metacharacters, and in addition, the dash symbol – becomes a metacharacter used to define ranges, using ASCII collation rules. It is also possible to use the character type escape sequences within a character class. Here are some examples: